

2.8 Changing Permissions At Command Prompt

This is accomplished by using the “**chmod**” command. The **chmod** is followed by a three-digit number used to indicate the permissions required. The first digit indicates the owner’s permission, the second digit the user group’s permission and the third is for all others.

The number coding is as follows:

7: full

6: read and write

5: read and execute

4: read only

3: write and execute

2: write only

1: execute only

0: none

Hence, the command “**chmod 777 filename**” will give full access to everybody to the file named “**filename**”. “**chmod 600 digit.doc**” will give only the owner of the file “**digit.doc**” the permission to view and edit the file. No one else will have any rights to it.

2.9 Compressing Files And Archiving In Linux Terminal

There are strong compression utilities in Linux that can be run easily from the command line. Linux features an archiving utility called “**tar**,” in which you can add many files, and the tar file will be treated as a single file. You may wonder how this is different from a folder.

Linux features the **zip** and **gzip** utilities to compress and extract (uncompress) files. There is also a **bzip** and **bzip2**, but we will talk about **zip** and **gzip**.

At the command prompt, use this format compress a file:
“**gzip filename**”

The file will be compressed and saved as **filename.gz**
To extract a compressed file: